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Hiring Committee
CIVICUS

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Research Intern position at CIVICUS. I am drawn to this opportunity because it combines rigorous research, policy-oriented writing, and a strong commitment to understanding and supporting civil society across different contexts. Coming from Vietnam and having worked on applied policy and development research, I am especially interested in how civil society, public institutions, and evidence-based analysis can contribute to more accountable and inclusive governance.

I recently worked as a Research Assistant at the Development and Policies Research Center (DEPOCEN), where I contributed to research projects on open data, SME finance, disaster impacts, disability inclusion, food safety, and trade efficiency. These projects trained me to review literature, gather and verify information, process data, synthesize findings, and support the preparation of research outputs for policy audiences. My work on evaluating open data portals in Vietnam is particularly relevant to CIVICUS, as it strengthened my interest in transparency, public access to information, and the role of data in improving governance.

Alongside project-based research, I have co-authored academic publications on trade flows, government policy responses, and firm performance. These experiences have helped me develop strong analytical and writing skills, as well as the ability to translate complex evidence into clear arguments. I am comfortable working with both quantitative and qualitative materials, and I have experience using Stata, R, QGIS, Python, $\LaTeX$, and Microsoft Office. I also have experience coordinating research-related activities and working with diverse teams through DEPOCEN, AVSE Global, MDRI, and VEPR.

What attracts me most to CIVICUS is the opportunity to learn more deeply about global civil society trends while contributing to concrete research outputs, including interviews, articles, reports, and dissemination activities. Although my previous work has been rooted mainly in economics and policy research, I see this internship as a natural extension of my interest in governance, civic participation, rights, and evidence-informed public debate. I would bring to the role a careful research mindset, strong writing discipline, and a perspective from the Global South.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my research experience and policy interests can contribute to CIVICUS' work.

Sincerely,

Huy Le Vu